

Secure communication

Credit card offers are often the vehicle of cybercrimes. Though you don't apply for the credit cards, tossing them carelessly in the dustbin would only mean that the miscreant can use your identity to apply for a new card. Call your credit card number and opt out of receiving such offers, especially by mail.

We live in an era of supersonic communication. But that doesn't mean that you don't keep an eye on the post box. The mail is a place where millions of personal information is handled every day and is the commonest route to identity theft. Pay attention to your email, especially the billing statements. Ensure that these statements are on time or better; opt for a paper-less statement through your email id. This way, you don't just reduce the risk to cybercrime but also do your bit for the environment.

Your computer is the hub for cybercrime. Many identity thieves use complicated software to break into your computer and elicit sensitive data like your passwords. You may not notice anything wrong but that doesn't mean that you are safe. Most cybercriminals use spyware and other stealth mechanisms to steal your data. The only way you can fight this is by installing a strong firewall in your computer, one that will provide utmost protection without wearing out the user experience.

When you are planning to get rid of your computer, ensure that you have erased all the information stored. Restore it to factory settings, for an added measure.

Most of us carry immense identifying information with us, either in our wallets or bags. If such should get stolen, it is easy for people to misuse the information to their advantage. Never carry credit cards or any other cards which can be used as a credit card. By doing this, you will reduce the damage, in case of theft. Carry if you must, ensure that you carry only one credit card. And, write SEE ID next to your signature.

Never carry any extra documents that you are not planning to use. Unless you are traveling, leave those extra checks and passport back home.

Social media safety

While using public computers, never check the "Save Password" box. Many social media forums auto check this box – so keep your eyes peeled for such possibilities.

Signing up for social media could be done with your full name. This way, you can prevent others from impersonating you on the internet. For those